

Generating the Mind of Awakening

Toh 811 · Derge Kangyur

This short text is Toh 811 in the Kangyur, a brief liturgical and devotional work often known in English as a prayer or verses for generating the mind of awakening. The Tibetan title lines supplied here break off before any title is given, and I cannot confirm a Sanskrit title from them, so I will not guess at one. It opens with homage to the Three Jewels and then proceeds in verse: the speaker, moved by the boundless suffering of sentient beings and fearing that cyclic existence offers no lasting happiness, resolves to generate the mind of awakening in order to rescue beings from the lower realms and free them from the mental afflictions. The verses go on to make aspirations to become a refuge and protector for all who lack one, and to dedicate whatever virtue has been gathered, in this life and others, for the welfare of beings. Within the canon it belongs to the Kangyur, the collection of translated words of the Buddha, and its character is that of a practice text or ritual aspiration of the sort recited in the cultivation of bodhicitta, the altruistic intention at the heart of the bodhisattva path.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

For the sake of the boundless realm of sentient beings,
that their suffering may be fully pacified,
that they may be rescued from the lower realms,
and delivered from the mental afflictions,
fearing that existence brings no happiness,
and seeing the many kinds of suffering that there are,
in order to protect them completely from these,
I generate the mind of awakening.

May I always be a refuge
for all sentient beings in need.

May I be a protector for those without protectors,
a support for those without support,
a refuge for those without refuge,
one who turns suffering into happiness.

May I bring about the pacification
of the mental afflictions of all sentient beings.

Whatever virtuous actions
I have gathered, in this life and in others,

may they become the accumulation
called merit and wisdom, the two kinds of accumulation.

Whatever diligent effort I undertake
through the gateway of the six perfections,
may that too bring benefit
to all sentient beings without exception.

Whatever, however slight, I do
to extend the limits of their lives,
in short, I strive in order that all the afflictions
of all sentient beings may be pacified
and that they may be liberated,
and I joyfully exert myself for awakening.

Then, having generated the awakening mind in its fullness,
in accordance with the ritual, in every respect,
I should cultivate compassion
and loving-kindness toward all sentient beings.

In order to train the mind well,
by various methods, through the six recollections,
with an inner self at peace,
I should meditate single-pointedly.

Just as the former sons of the Victors
made their aspirations,
so too I, with a virtuous mind,
make aspirations in just the same way.

Settled in meditative equipoise
upon the various riches of the Dharma, I rejoice.
May all sentient beings be happy,
at peace, and free from illness.

May I be capable in all that I do,
and may I possess good qualities as well.
May I be wealthy, generous, courageous, and wise,
patient, and first to take up virtue.

And in all the lives of sentient beings,
may I remember my births and be endowed with love.

The passage ends here, in the middle of a title or colophon line: "The great tantra that brings about glorious excellence..."

Translator's Notes

- The final line is an incomplete fragment, apparently the start of a title or a new text; I have not rendered it as part of the prayer. Lines such as "extend the limits of their lives" and "whatever, however slight, I do" appear corrupt or garbled in the source (the text also has stray spacing and a missing shad), so the rendering there is tentative. "Six recollections" (rjes dran drug) refers to the traditional six: Buddha, Dharma, Saṅgha, generosity, ethical discipline, and deities.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.